



JavaScript Basics Overview

Brief Overview

This note covers **JavaScript Basics** and was created from a 3-page PDF([3-page PDF](#)). It explains how browsers differentiate code from text, introduces **core data types**, demonstrates console arithmetic, shows how to use the typeof operator, and previews variables.

Key Points

- Identify strings versus executable code
 - Understand the main data types (string, number, boolean)
 - Practice arithmetic directly in the JavaScript console
 - Get ready to learn about variables in the next lesson
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How the Browser Parses Code

- The browser distinguishes **code** from **text** by using quotation marks ("").
- Anything enclosed in quotes is treated as a **string** and is **not** executed as code.

String – A sequence of characters enclosed in quotation marks that the computer interprets as literal text rather than executable code.



Introduction to Data Types

- A **data type** classifies a piece of data so the computer knows how it should be handled.
- The most common data type for display text is the **string**, which is simply a “string of characters”.

Data Type – A label that tells the programming language how to interpret, store, and manipulate a value.



Common Data Types

Data Type	Example	Description
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String	"Hello"	Text enclosed in quotes; not executed as code.
Number	42	Numeric value; no special symbols required.
Boolean	true / false	Represents logical truth values.

Console Practice

1. Open the JavaScript console: **View → Developer → JavaScript Console**.
2. You can perform arithmetic directly:
 - $2 + 3 = 5$ (type $2 + 3$ and press **Enter**).
3. Run the earlier alert example to display the result in a pop-up:

```
alert(2 + 3);
```

- After pressing **Enter**, a pop-up appears showing **5**.

Other Keywords

- `typeof()` reports the data type of the value inside its parentheses.

```
typeof 23;           // "number"
typeof "my name";    // "string"
typeof true;         // "boolean"
```

typeof – An operator that returns a string indicating the data type of its operand.

17 Next Lesson Preview

- Upcoming focus: **variables**, the fundamental building block for storing and reusing data in all programming languages.